

Hendrik Erz, PhD

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Research Interests

Political Sociology, Computational Social Science, Analytical Sociology, Computational Text Analysis/NLP, Legislative Debates, U.S. Congress, Science of Science, Ethics of AI

Education

- 2025** **PhD in Analytical Sociology, Linköping University**
- On the Record: Understanding A Century of Congressional Lawmaking Through Speech and Vote Behavior**
Supervisors: Jacob Habinek (IAS, Linköping), Étienne Ollion (CNRS, Paris)
Committee: Andrei Boutyline; Marshall A. Taylor, Alexandra Segerberg, Andreas Schmitz, Daniel Ritter
- 2017** M.A. in Sociology, University of Bonn
- 2014** B.A. in History, University of Bonn (minor: Political Science)

Extracurricular

- 2021** Science of Science Summer School (S4)
Syracuse University, New York, United States

Employment

- Since 2025** **Researcher in Analytical Sociology**
Institute for Analytical Sociology (IAS)
Linköping University
- 2020-25** **PhD Student in Analytical Sociology**
Institute for Analytical Sociology (IAS)
Linköping University
- 2019-20** **Researcher in Machine Learning / Artificial Intelligence**
Institute for Peace Research and Security Policy (IFSH)
University of Hamburg
- 2017-19** **Research Assistant Domestic Policy / Digitalization**
Department for Political Science and Sociology
University of Bonn

Publications

Manuscripts in Preparation (available upon request)

Hendrik Erz. Policymaking in Times of Crisis: Discursive Dynamics in U.S. Congress, 1960-1990. (Preprint available at SocArXiv: https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/fxrzk_v1)

Hendrik Erz. Brittle Parties? Dissent, Breaking Ranks, and Party Power in U.S. Congress.

Hendrik Erz. Measuring Issue-Level Polarization in Congressional Speech Using Community Detection-Algorithms. (*Under review*)

Hendrik Erz, Sebastian Giessler. Language Models from the Sweatshop? Helping Researchers Avoid Ethical and Legal Issues With Off-The-Shelf Software.

Alexandra Dirksen, Sebastian Giessler, **Hendrik Erz**. Ethics in Computer Science and Security Research.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

2025 Manika Lamba, **Hendrik Erz** (2025). Thanking the World: Exploring gender-based differences in acknowledgment patterns and support systems in theses. *Data and Information Management* 100092. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.dim.2024.100092>

2024 Alexandra Dirksen, Sebastian Giessler, **Hendrik Erz**, Martin Johns, Tobias Fiebig (2024). Don't Patch the Researcher, Patch the Game: A Systematic Approach for Responsible Research via Federated Ethics Boards. *Proceedings of the New Security Paradigms Workshop*, 126–141. New York, NY, USA: Association for Computing Machinery. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3703465.3703475>

2019 **Hendrik Erz** (2019). Der lange Schatten von Gustave Le Bon. Zum sprachlichen Einfluss der Crowd Science auf die Soziologie der Gewalt. *Soziologiemagazin* 2/2019, 71–88. <https://doi.org/10.3224/soz.v12i2.06>
(*"The long shadow of Gustave Le Bon. On the linguistic influence of Crowd Science on the Sociology of Violence."*)

Books and Book Chapters

2025 **Hendrik Erz** (2025). On the Record: Understanding a Century of Congressional Lawmaking through Speech and Vote Behavior. Linköping University Press. <https://doi.org/10.3384/9789181182828>

2018 **Hendrik Erz** (2018). Karl Marx und das digitale Zeitalter, in: Klasse, Kapital und Revolution. 200 Jahre Marx. Dietz, Bonn, pp. 145–156.

Other Publications

2023 **Hendrik Erz**, Anastasia Menshikova (2023). Text als Daten. Extraktion von Variablen mittels LSTM-Netzwerken. In: Paula-Irene Villa (ed.) 2023: *Polarisierte Welten. Verhandlungen des 41. Kongresses der Deutschen Gesellschaft für Soziologie 2022*. https://publikationen.sozilogie.de/index.php/kongressband_2022/article/view/1693
(*"Text as Data. Variable Extraction via LSTM Networks"*)

- 2020** **Hendrik Erz** (2020). Künstliche Intelligenz und Daten: Eine Evaluation softwarebasierter militärischer Informationsgewinnung (Research Report No. 4). IFSH, Hamburg. https://ifsh.de/file/publication/Research_Report/004/20200701_Research_Report_004.pdf (accessed 07.01.21)
 (“*Artificial Intelligence and data: An evaluation of software-based military intelligence.*”)
- Hendrik Erz** (2020). Operative Porträts: eine Bildgeschichte der Identifizierbarkeit von Lavater bis Facebook. Von Roland Meyer. Review. Soziologiemagazin 2020, 75–81. <https://doi.org/10.3224/soz.v13i1.07>
- Hendrik Erz** (2020). The Status Quo is a Dystopian Nightmare. *engagée* 9, 20–25.
- 2019** **Hendrik Erz** (2019). Neoliberalismus — Wie alles anfangt: Das Walter Lippmann Kolloquium. Review. Soziologieblog. <https://soziologieblog.hypotheses.org/12990> (accessed 10.23.19).
- Andreas Schulz, **Hendrik Erz**, Veronika Riedl (2019). How to make a Soziologiemagazin. Soziologiemagazin 1/2019. <https://elibrary.utb.de/doi/pdf/10.3224/soz.v12i2.08> (accessed 07.01.21)
- 2017** **Hendrik Erz** (2017). Zygmunt Bauman: Die Angst vor den anderen. Review. Widerspruch 70/2017, 164–168.

Awards & Grants

- 2026** **IEI resebidrag till disputerade forskare våren 2026**, Linköpings University (SEK 21,000; decision DNR IEI-2026-00294)

Invited Talks

- 2026** **Ethical Governance and Practices in Security & Privacy Research**
 IAS Annual Spring Retreat, Kolmården, Sweden
- 2025** **Vote Defection and Party Pressure in U.S. Congress: Evidence from a Century of Vote and Speech Behavior**
 IAS Annual Spring Retreat, Kolmården, Sweden
- 2024** **Economic Policymaking in U.S. Congress**
 Institute for Social Science, Department for Computational Social Science
 University of Stuttgart, Germany
- Economic Policymaking in U.S. Congress**
 IAS Annual Spring Retreat, Kolmården, Sweden
- 2023** **Polarization and Paradigm Shifts in US Congressional Economic Policy-making**
 IAS Text Analysis Research Group, Norrköping, Sweden
- 2022** **Discursive Dynamics in Policymaking: Economic Policymaking in U.S. Congress**
 IAS Conference, Stockholm, Sweden
- 2022** **Technological A11y: Zettlr Beyond the Code**
 Staatliche Hochschule für Gestaltung, Karlsruhe, Germany

Conference and Workshop Presentations

- 2025** **Vote Defection and Party Pressure in U.S. Congress**
International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)
Norrköping, Sweden
- Vote Defection and Party Power in U.S. Congress**
Conference of the International Network of Analytical Sociologists (INAS)
Columbia University, New York, USA
- Vote Defection and Party Power in U.S. Congress**
Joint Spring Conference of the methods sections of DGS and AS
University of Leipzig, Germany
- 2024** **Language Models from the Sweatshop? Helping Researchers Avoid Ethical and Legal Issues With Off-The-Shelf Software**
Conference of the Nordic Sociological Association (NSA) 2024, Norrköping, Sweden
(in session Pretrained models and sociology)
- Policymaking in Times of Crisis: Discursive Dynamics in U.S. Congress, 1960-1990**
Conference of the American Sociological Association (ASA) 2024, Montréal, Canada
- Markets as actors: Congressional speech between regulation and market freedom**
Conference of the International Network of Analytical Sociologists (INAS), Leipzig, Germany
- Economic Policymaking in U.S. Congress** (Lightning Talk)
Swedish Conference on Computational Social Science, Uppsala, Sweden
- 2023** **Language Models from the Sweatshop? Towards Guidelines For CSS Researchers to Avoid Ethical and Legal Issues With Off-The-Shelf Software.**
(Poster)
International Conference on Computational Social Sciences (IC2S2), Copenhagen, Denmark
- From Speeches to Bills: How do Discursive Dynamics Shape Policymaking in U.S. Congress?**
Conference of the International Network of Analytical Sociologists (INAS), Princeton, United States
- Taming Rogue Ethics: The Case for a Unified and Fair IRB Procedure**
STS-hub.de Conference, Rheinisch-Westfälische Technische Hochschule (RWTH) Aachen, Germany
- Disentangling the Discourse on U.S. Economic Policymaking**
Textual Politics Conference, Sciences Po, Paris, France.
- 2022** **Text als Daten: Extraktion von Variablen mittels LSTM-Netzwerken**
Kongress der Deutschen Gesellschaft für Soziologie, Bielefeld, Germany.
- Extracting Agency from Textual Data Using LSTM Networks**
Conference of the International Network of Analytical Sociologists, Florence, Italy.
- 2019** **From Arab Spring to Gilets Jaunes: Riots and the annihilation of legality**
Historical Materialism Athens Conference, Greece.

2017 **Terrorismus und der War on Terror**
 Master Thesis Presentation, Studentischer Soziologiekongress, TU Chemnitz, Germany.

Teaching

2025 **Python Workshop**
 M.Sc. program; Lecturer; Linköping University
 Full-day custom workshop with lecture parts introducing set-up, syntax, data analysis, and text classification with BERT

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS)
 Lecture and workshop in ethics for CSS
 Lecture and workshop in Computational Text Analysis

Since 2024 **Behavioral Mechanisms in the Social Sciences**
 M.Sc. program; Lecturer (course director: Rodrigo Martínez Peña); Linköping University

Since 2022 **Digital Strategies for the Social Sciences**
 M.Sc. program; Teaching Assistant (2022-2024) and Course Director (Since 2025); Linköping University

2023 **Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS)**
 Lecture and workshop in Computational Text Analysis

2021-2023 **Logic of Social Inquiry**
 M.Sc. program; Teaching Assistant; Linköping University

2018-2019 **Introduction to Political Science**
 B.A. program; Teacher; University of Bonn

2018 **Scientific Writing**
 B.A. program; Teacher; University of Bonn

2018 **Introduction to Karl Marx' Capital (Reading Course)**
 B.A. program; Course Director; University of Bonn

2015 **Tutorial: Methods for Quantitative Sociology**
 B.A. program; Teaching Assistant; University of Bonn

Service

Reviewer

Since 2025 Network Science

Since 2018 Soziologiemagazin

Editorial Board Member

2020-2024 Head of Editorial Board, Soziologiemagazin

Organization and Organizational Assistance

Since 2023 Swedish Interdisciplinary Research School in Computational Social Science (SIRCSS), Norrköping, Sweden (with PI Jacob Habinek)

Since 2022	Website administration and newsletter; International Network of Analytical Sociologists (INAS)
2026	Program Chair, CS2Nordics Conference Program Chair, Workshop on Metascience and Critical Reflections in Security & Privacy (MetaCRiSP; Part of the IEEE Symposium on Security & Privacy)
2025	Program Chair, International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), Norrköping
2025	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Norrköping, Sweden (with PI Jacob Habinek)
2024	Session Pretrained models and sociology: ethical, methodological, and theoretical considerations (at NSA 2024)
2023	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), Norrköping, Sweden (with PI Jacob Habinek)
2022	IAS PhD Retreat, Norrköping, Sweden
2021-2022	IAS Salon (Institute Reading Group)
2021-2022	PhD Representative, Institute for Analytical Sociology
2016	Student Research Symposium, University of Bonn, Germany

Supervision

Co-Supervisor, M.Sc. thesis in CSS: Nino Janashia (2026); Muhammad Hossain Abbas (2026); Sophia Grill (2024); Yiqiu Wang (2023); Lijun Peng (2022)

Memberships

American Sociological Association (ASA);
International Network of Analytical Sociologists (INAS)
German Sociological Association (DGS)
Nordic Society for Computational Social Science (NoSoCSS)

Referees

Prof. Dr. Jacob Habinek, Linköping University, Sweden
Prof. Dr. Étienne Ollion, École Polytechnique, Paris, France
Prof. Dr. Marc Keuschnigg, University of Leipzig, Germany
Prof. Dr. Marshall A. Taylor, New Mexico State University, United States

Academic Software

Since 2017	Zettlr (Project Maintainer)
Since 2024	Pandoc (Contributor)

Languages

German (native), English (fluent, C1 IELTS),
Swedish (Moderate, A2), French (Moderate, A2)

Programming Languages & Frameworks

Scientific	Python, R, Stata, matplotlib, numpy, pandas, PyTorch, Slurm (HPC)
Frontend	JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML/CSS, Vue.js
Backend	Node.js, PHP, Rust, C/C++, Bash/ZSH, SQL